

Chapter 109-1

Completing KPI.....

Liang Shi, who hadn't been in the workplace for a long time, was dazed for a second before she understood—it meant performance evaluation.

Xu Qingzhu was too smart.

She could deduce a logical thread purely from events that had already occurred, piecing together a clear logical line through guessing and deduction. Then she would probe and test, judging whether something was true based on the other person's expression.

Liang Shi, who was used to being honest, was truly no match for her.

But tonight's matter wasn't about completing a task for Liang Shi. She simply felt this scene was too beautiful and really wanted to hear Xu Qingzhu read poetry.

Her cool voice reading English poetry would definitely sound wonderful.

Moreover, when Liang Shi looked at her, she had already placed a hazy filter over her. But the moment she opened her mouth.....

Crack.

The filter shattered.

Instantly returning to reality, Liang Shi propped herself up on her arm, lying on her side, and said helplessly: "Xu Qingzhu, can you occasionally not overthink things?"

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow at her, her smile carrying a hint of provocation. "For example?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She paused for a moment: "For example, just now I simply wanted to hear you read poetry."

"What about before?" Xu Qingzhu said. "Was it simple when you went to the escape room?"

Liang Shi: "....."

There was no way to play this game.

Xu Qingzhu continued: "May I ask, Miss Liang, was your invitation for me to go to the escape room also very simple? Was it your own subjective wish to invite me to such a pitch-black place, to embark on a dreamlike journey together?"

Liang Shi: "....."

At the mention of that escape room, Liang Shi's scalp still tingled.

She couldn't even think about it.

Yet Xu Qingzhu's words carried a hint of teasing, without the urgency of someone who absolutely needed to know the answer. She was just teasing Liang Shi.

You could tell from her mischievous gaze.

But Liang Shi happened to be someone who couldn't handle teasing—she couldn't withstand Xu Qingzhu's casual questions and those lightly-cast glances.

In that instant, Liang Shi felt as if she wasn't wearing any clothes.

Her entire being, inside and out, had been seen through by Xu Qingzhu.

With Xu Qingzhu's heat period approaching, her pheromones would faintly emanate from time to time. The room was permeated with the light scent of strawberry Baileys.

Liang Shi held her breath and didn't answer her question.

Xu Qingzhu, leaning against the headboard, slid down softly a bit, getting closer to Liang Shi—close enough to see her eyes especially clearly.

Liang Shi met her gaze, then guiltily looked away after a moment.

In the end, Liang Shi couldn't hold back and said quietly: "Teacher Xu, life is hard enough—don't expose people."¹

Xu Qingzhu laughed: "Really? I feel....."

"Your feeling is wrong." Liang Shi denied.

Xu Qingzhu let out a soft, questioning hum from her nose: "Is that so?"

When she asked "Is that so?" it was full of pressure, as if she was saying—you're lying to me.

Liang Shi closed her eyes briefly, trying to keep her tone relaxed. "Of course. I just wanted to hear you read poetry."

She met Xu Qingzhu's gaze again and even argued with her: "You asked me to sing, and I sang. So you reading me a poem isn't too much to ask, is it?"

As she said this, Liang Shi lacked confidence, her heart still pounding.

She was terrified that if Xu Qingzhu pushed any deeper, Liang Shi would directly reveal the existence of the system.

Even though the system said she couldn't possibly reveal the system to anyone, Xu Qingzhu would find other ways to get it out of her.

Liang Shi was dancing on the edge of danger.

Fortunately, Xu Qingzhu was only teasing her and didn't have any intention of absolutely needing to know. So after Liang Shi showed a hesitant look, she withdrew all her pressure and laughed lightly: "Of course it's not too much."

Xu Qingzhu's hair fell down onto the pillow. Liang Shi's idle hand had nothing to do, so she played with the ends of her hair.

The fine, soft strands seemed to come alive in an instant, winding around Liang Shi's fingers, round and round.

Xu Qingzhu watched Liang Shi and said with a light laugh: "Whatever Teacher Liang asks for is never too much."

These words were full of indulgence, yet they were spoken by Xu Qingzhu of all people.

Liang Shi felt she was being passive-aggressively mocked.

Her hand passed through Xu Qingzhu's fine, soft hair and lightly pinched her waist.

An Omega's body was especially sensitive near her heat period. Just being lightly touched made her let out a soft whimper.

It made one's heart tremble to hear.

Even knowing she shouldn't, it still made people have improper thoughts.

Wanting to make her cry out again.

Even if it meant losing her own soul in the process.

Liang Shi's hand, through her pajamas, reined itself in at the edge of danger. She let that thought remain just a thought without acting on it.

Her hand traced past Xu Qingzhu's fine, soft hair as she said quietly: "Don't tease me."

Xu Qingzhu couldn't help but laugh. "Why do you get annoyed so easily?"

Liang Shi looked at her.

Xu Qingzhu's eyes were bright and sparkling. When she smiled, her eyes curved, and those beautiful pupils reflected the light.

Liang Shi suddenly smiled along with her: "You should think about whether it's because you're too annoying when you speak."

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow: "It's alright, I'm already restraining myself when facing Teacher Liang."

Liang Shi: "I feel like you only target me."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

After a moment of being at a loss for words, Xu Qingzhu's gaze fell on the yellowed pages of the book. Her tone was languid and casual: "Anyway, isn't it enough that you're the special one?"

Her cool voice carried an indescribable meaning, as if she had taken a feather and was gently tickling Liang Shi's heart.

Liang Shi's hand, which had been playing with her hair, paused. But she still couldn't help herself—her hand fell on her waist again and gave it a light pinch.

Xu Qingzhu let out another soft hum.

Xu Qingzhu looked at Liang Shi's mischievous hand, then looked at Liang Shi. "Teacher Liang, you seem very active today."

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, her eyes blinking at her. "Really?"

Xu Qingzhu's hand suddenly spread open and came to rest in front of her eyelashes.

Liang Shi's eyelashes brushed against her palm.

Liang Shi said softly: "Because you said that Liang Shi can be herself."

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1. "人艱不拆" (rén jiān bù chāi) is a Chinese internet slang phrase, short for "人生已經如此艱難，有些事情就不要拆穿" meaning "Life is already so difficult, so don't expose certain things." It's used to ask someone not to point out or expose something awkward or embarrassing. ↩